

Sales Squad Assignment

Imagine you have joined Volopay's Sales Squad.

The Scenario

Your role is to create demand and move a finance buyer towards a serious next step for Spend Management.

Volopay Spend Management helps finance teams manage corporate cards, expenses, reimbursements, accounts payable, approvals and business payments in one platform, giving businesses better visibility and control over company spending while reducing manual finance work.

This assignment should show whether you can research an account, identify a credible finance problem, reach the right stakeholders, run a sharp first conversation, pitch simply, handle objections, and control the next step.

You may use AI and any other tools, but all claims, assumptions, sources, and final outputs must be defensible. Do not invent product capabilities, ROI, integrations, security claims, or customer results.

Task 1: Build an Account Selection and Qualification Brief

Identify 10 real companies that could be relevant targets for Volopay Spend Management.

For each account, include:

- Company name
- Industry and geography
- Public signal that makes the account relevant
- Likely finance workflow complexity
- Which finance process may be painful or manual
- Likely senior buyer
- Likely operational user or influencer
- Existing tools or current workaround they may use
- Why now may be a good time to approach
- Biggest uncertainty or disqualification risk
- Source links

Score each account out of 5 on:

- Strength of business trigger
- Likelihood of a real finance operations problem
- Potential value of solving the problem
- Ability to identify the right stakeholders
- Strength of evidence

Then select one priority account and write a qualification brief covering:

- Why this account is the strongest target
- The exact problem hypothesis you would test
- What is verified vs assumed
- What would make this opportunity worth pursuing
- What would make you disqualify or pause the account

Submission for Task 1:

Submit one Google Sheet or table containing the 10-account list, scoring, source links, and one-page priority account brief.

Task 2: Create a Multi-Stakeholder Demand Generation Sprint

Using the priority account from Task 1, create a coordinated outreach sprint for two stakeholders:

- 1. Senior finance buyer, such as CFO, VP Finance, Finance Director, Controller, or Head of Finance
- 2. Operational stakeholder, such as Finance Ops, AP, AR, Accounting, Procurement, or Shared Services owner

The outreach should not be generic. It should connect the public signal, the likely spend-management problem, and the reason Volopay may be relevant.

Create:

- LinkedIn connection message
- First email to senior buyer
- First email or LinkedIn message to operational stakeholder
- 30-second cold-call opener
- Follow-up message if there is no response
- Close-the-loop message
- One creative engagement asset or concept that could help get attention. Choose any format or medium you think is appropriate for the account and stakeholder.

For every touch, include:

- Recipient
- Channel
- Message
- Purpose
- Customer action requested
- Why this message fits the stakeholder
- What you would do if they do not respond

Submission for Task 2:

Submit the outreach sequence and source links used for personalisation. For the creative engagement piece, use any format you think works best. Share a working link or file where relevant, or explain the concept clearly if it cannot be directly submitted.

Task 3: Prepare for Discovery and Qualification

Assume the senior buyer agrees to a 20-minute first conversation.

Prepare a discovery plan that would help you understand whether this is a real opportunity.

Include:

- Your opening for the call
- The meeting objective
- What you need to understand about their current spend-management setup
- 6 sharp discovery questions you would ask
- 2 follow-up questions you would ask depending on the buyer's answer
- What would make you believe this is a strong opportunity
- What would make you pause the opportunity
- Who else you would need to involve
- The next step you would ask for if the call goes well

The questions should go beyond basic pain-point questions and help uncover the current process, manual work, gaps in the existing tool or provider, spend and transaction complexity, controls, decision process, urgency and willingness to change.

Submission for Task 3:

Submit one document section containing the discovery plan, questions and qualification logic.

Task 4: Record the Sales Pitch, Objection Response, and Next-Step Close

Record one video of up to 6 minutes.

Part 1: Sales pitch

Pitch Volopay Spend Management to the senior buyer at your priority account.

The pitch should:

- Open with the account-specific problem hypothesis
- Explain why the problem matters commercially or operationally
- Position Volopay Spend Management in simple language
- Connect the product to the specific workflow pain
- Avoid sounding like a generic spend management pitch
- Avoid invented ROI, customer outcomes, or unsupported claims
- Show why this is worth exploring now

Part 2: Objection handling

Respond naturally to these three situations in the same video:

Situation A:

"We already have an expense management or corporate card solution in place."

Situation B:

"We find your service very expensive"

Situation C:

"We are not looking to buy anything this quarter."

For each situation:

- Respond naturally and keep the conversation credible
- Ask the next question you would use to understand the situation
- Decide whether you would continue, nurture or stop pursuing the opportunity
- Suggest a reasonable next step.

Part 3: Next-step close

End by asking for a specific next step.

The next step should be proportionate to the opportunity, such as:

- product walkthrough or tailored demo
- problem-mapping call with the operational owner
- sample process walkthrough
- proof-of-value discussion
- internal stakeholder meeting

Submission for Task 4:

Submit one open-access video link. The video must play directly without requesting access.

Evaluation Criteria

We will evaluate the assignment on:

- Account selection quality
- Research depth
- Strength of evidence
- Commercial judgment
- Quality of outreach
- Discovery depth
- Ability to handle ambiguity
- Sales communication
- Objection handling
- Closing intent
- Accuracy and defensibility
- Smart use of AI/tools
- Whether the output feels usable in a real sales motion